Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	21 September 2026
Team ID	Individual Project
Project Name	ServiceNow-Based Employee Laptop Request Application
Maximum Marks	4 Marks
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Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes. It helps the team understand the true problem and the person experiencing it before designing a solution. For this project, the problem is how employees of a new IT organization request laptops, and how managers and the IT team handle those requests today using emails and verbal communication.

User Profiles

User	Role in the process	What they need
Employee (Requester)	Submits a laptop request and waits for approval and delivery.	A simple form, a clear request type (Basic or Advance), and visible status.
Manager (Approver)	Reviews the reason and approves or rejects the request.	All request details in one place, and an auditable approval record.
IT / Management team	Fulfils approved requests and monitors asset allocation.	Tracking, reporting and no duplicate requests, for transparent asset allocation.

Empathy Map: Employee Laptop Request (Current Manual Process)

THINK & FEEL

- Will my request get lost in an email thread?
- Has my manager approved it yet?
- I need a laptop to start my work on time.
- Am I eligible for a Basic or an Advance laptop?
- What if I make a mistake? Only one request is allowed per year.
- Why do I have to explain the same reason again and again?

HEAR

- Manager: "Send me an email with your requirement."
- IT team: "Only one laptop request is allowed per employee per year."
- Colleagues: "My laptop request took weeks."
- Team lead: "Mention a clear reason: development, personal use or other."
- IT: "Advance laptops are only for software development or technical work."

SEE

- Requests scattered across emails, chats and verbal messages.
- No single place to track the status of a request.
- Colleagues submitting repeated requests with no response.
- Every employee using a different request format.
- IT staff keeping manual lists to track who got a laptop.
- No visibility into pending, approved or rejected requests.

SAY & DO
• "Can you check the status of my laptop request?" • "I already sent this by email last week." • Sends emails and verbal requests to the manager and IT team. • Follows up repeatedly to ask for status. • Resubmits the request when there is no reply.

PAIN (fears, frustrations, obstacles)	GAIN (wants, needs, measures of success)
• No visibility into request status or approval stage. • Manual, email-based and verbal process with no standard format. • Duplicate and untracked requests from the same employee. • Delays and no accountability for approvals. • No record of the reason or request type (Basic / Advance). • No reporting for IT and management on asset allocation.	• One centralized Service Portal form to request a laptop. • Clear status: Pending Approval, Approved or Rejected. • Request type chosen by need: Basic or Advance. • Reason captured for justification. • Duplicate requests blocked: one request per employee per year. • Easy tracking and reporting for IT and management.

Key Insights and How the Solution Responds

Insight from the empathy map	ServiceNow solution feature
Employees cannot see where their request is.	Status field (Pending Approval / Approved / Rejected) on the Laptop Request Form table.
Requests come through emails and verbal messages.	Record Producer on the Service Portal as the single front-end entry point.
The same employee requests repeatedly.	Business rule restricting one laptop request per employee per year, with an error message for duplicates.
Managers lack context to approve.	Reference fields (Requester, Manager), Type of Request and Reason captured on every request.
IT has no overall view.	Role-based access control now, with approvals, notifications and reporting prepared for later phases.

Reference: https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas